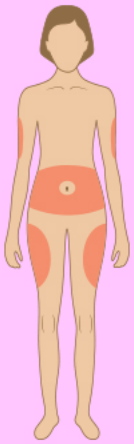
Injections: Subcutaneous

Purpose: To administer medications more rapidly than the oral route of administration

Nursing considerations

- Can be delegated the LVN but not UAP.
- **Locations:** Abdomen, Thigh, Lower back, Upper Arm.
- **Considerations:** Consider age, medication type, medication volume. Tell the client to rotate injections to avoid hardening of the area. Ask the client which site they would prefer.



Needle sizes

- 25 to 27 gague needle 3/8 to 5/8"
- Byetta for diabetes recommends using 30 or 31 gauge 1/3 inch needles which are ultra fine.



Equipment

- Gloves.
- PPE.
- Medication.
- Sterile syringe and needle of appropriate size and gauge.
- Antimicrobial swab.
- Small gauze square.
- MAR.

Procedure

1. Gather equipment and check MAR (1st check).
2. Know the actions, indications and considerations of the medication to be administered.
3. Perform hand hygiene.
4. Gather medications from the med room and prepare meds for one client at a time.
5. Check the medication with the MAR (2nd check) and check expiration dates, perform calculations and scan the barcode.
6. Lock the medication prior to leaving it.
7. Transport medications, keeping them in sight at all times.
8. Perform hand hygiene, provide privacy, check client ID, check medications with client name and DOB on the MAR (3rd check) have another nurse check accuracy of dose when giving insulin.
9. Put on clean gloves.
10. Select administration site.
11. Position the client, only exposing areas needed to perform the procedure.
12. Cleanse the area around the site with an anti- microbial swab and allow the area to dry.
13. Remove the needle cap.
14. Inject needle into the tissue at a 90 or 45 degree angle.
15. As soon as the needle is in place use the thumb and forefinger of your non-dominant hand to inject the solution.
16. Wait 10 seconds before withdrawing the needle, withdraw smoothly and steadily.
17. Apply gentle pressure to the site, do not massage the area.
18. Engage the safety shield and do not recap the needle.
19. Discard equipment in the appropriate biohazard container.
20. Remove gloves and PPE.
21. Perform hand hygiene.
22. Document.
23. Evaluate



Rights of medication administration

1. Right patient
2. Right dose
3. Right route
4. Right medication
5. Right time
6. Right documentation

Documentation

- Record the medications given.
- Record date.
- Time.
- Site.
- If the client refused.
- If you held or omitted.
- Ongoing assessments and evaluations after admin.



Complications

- Pain and swelling at the injection site
- Hypersensitivity - reactions to medications.
- Slight fever.
- Monitor client for reactions.